APPLICATION PREP · NOVEMBER 9, 2026 · SAMPLE WITH A FICTIONAL PERSON AND COMPANY

Senior Brand Designer at Northwind Studios

Strong fit. Alex has led brand systems for two consumer launches; the gap is motion, and the reel covers most of it.

5/6	78%	$125–150K	Nov 14
MUST-HAVES MET	KEYWORD COVERAGE	POSTED PAY	APPLY BY
motion is partial	14 of 18 terms	plus equity, remote US	posted Nov 3; apply in week 2

01 Fit check

THEY NEED	YOUR STRONGEST EVIDENCE		HOW TO HANDLE IT
6+ years in brand design	8 years: 5 in-house, 3 at an agency	STRONG	Say it once in the summary line; don't repeat it.
Built a brand system end to end	Led the Fable Foods rebrand: logo, type, color, 40-page guidelines	STRONG	Lead the portfolio with it (see 03).
Packaging and retail	32 SKUs across two grocery launches	STRONG	Put the SKU count in the first bullet.
Motion and social	Art-directed launch reels; didn't animate them	PARTIAL	Name your role plainly: "art-directed", not "animated".
Mentoring designers	Managed two juniors for 18 months	STRONG	Add one line on how they grew.
Figma design-system tooling	Built the Fable component library, 120 components	STRONG	Mention variables and tokens by name.

02 Keywords

Covered

brand identity, brand system, guidelines, packaging, art direction, Figma, design system, typography, campaign, retail, cross-functional, mentoring, launch, illustration

Missing

After Effects (true: you've used it for storyboards, so add it). **Brand strategy** (true for Fable; add to the summary). **Accessibility** (true: contrast audit on Fable; add a bullet). **3D** (not true; leave it out).

03 Portfolio: lead with these

01 Fable Foods rebrand
Their top need is an end-to-end system. Frame it as "a rebrand that shipped across 32 SKUs in nine months."

02 Harbor Tea launch campaign
Shows art direction across packaging, social and retail. Frame it around the launch reel and your role on it.

03 Fable component library
Answers the Figma requirement with something concrete. Show one page of tokens and one of components.

04 Outreach drafts

> To the Design Director · LinkedIn · send the day you apply
>
> Hi Sam, I just applied for the Senior Brand Designer role. I led the Fable Foods rebrand, which took a 40-page system onto 32 grocery SKUs in nine months, and Northwind's work for Tidewater reads like the next step from that. I'd love to hear how the team splits brand and motion work. Portfolio: alexrivera.design

> To the recruiter · email · send if no reply in 6 business days
>
> Hi Priya, following up on my application for Senior Brand Designer (submitted Nov 12). Happy to share a short walkthrough of the Fable rebrand if that's useful for the team. Thanks for your time.

05 Interview stories

Brand system	**Fable's packaging didn't match its new positioning.** Led a nine-month rebrand with strategy and two designers. Shipped across 32 SKUs; retail buyers added 3 new chains that year.
Motion	**Harbor Tea needed a launch reel with no in-house animator.** Wrote the boards, hired a freelancer, art-directed six rounds. The reel ran in paid social through launch.
Mentoring	**Two junior designers were stuck on production work.** Gave each a system piece to own and weekly crits. Both led their own packaging lines within a year.

06 Questions to ask

01 How is brand work split between this role and the motion team?
Tells you how much of the motion gap matters day to day.

02 What would a great first 90 days look like?
Shows what they're hiring to fix.

07 Follow-up schedule

Nov 12
Apply, and send the LinkedIn note to the Design Director

Nov 20
Email the recruiter if there's no reply

Made with the free Application Kit skill for Claude, by Beautiful Engine · beautifulengine.com